How Automation and the DeepRoots Portal Help Every Department

Donor presentation talking points · Coming year: December 2026 – 2027

Department	Today (manual)	With the Portal	Result	When
Sales (new schools)	A new school takes 10 steps and 10+ hand-offs between sales and accounting. Website enquiries reach no one automatically. Demos, samples and follow-ups are tracked by hand. Deals take about 2 months to close.	Enquiries go straight to the right ambassador with an automatic welcome. Demos are booked online. Schools accept a quote online, the agreement and invoice are created, and payment starts set-up. Stalled deals prompt the owner at 14 and 30 days.	2–3 hand-offs instead of 10+. Ambassadors spend time selling, not on paperwork.	Dec–Feb
Renewals	About 390 renewals a year, each passing through 15+ hand-offs and taking 2–3 weeks plus set-up. Some go 60 days overdue before anyone follows up.	Each renewal is prepared 90 days early, with automatic reminders at 60, 30 and 7 days. Schools renew online, and staff handle exceptions only.	0–1 hand-offs per renewal. Fewer missed renewals.	Dec–Jan
Onboarding & set-up	4,000+ set-up tasks since April. Info sheets and logins chased by hand. Classroom-roster syncs average 11+ days. In June, 6 people handle up to 390 schools.	A priority set-up queue, an online info sheet, school admin accounts created at purchase, roster syncs flagged after 48 hours, and Google/Clever sign-in.	From payment to teaching in 1–2 days instead of 5–7.	Dec–Feb
Marketing	Website changes need a developer. Conference results are tracked as notes. There is no "Book a Demo" path.	Marketing edits the website itself. Online demo booking and a website help chat. Each conference and campaign is tracked from enquiry to demo to sale.	Spend goes where it wins schools, and messaging can change in days.	Now–Feb
Customer support	Questions arrive by email and phone, with history scattered across tools.	An in-app help inbox with AI sorting (tech, billing, curriculum, sales), response-time alerts, a self-help library, and AI answers drawn only from approved content.	Faster answers and fewer repeat questions.	Dec–Feb
Finance & billing	About 5 manual estimate and invoice tasks per school in QuickBooks. A spreadsheet updated daily by hand. Payments chased manually.	Quote, invoice and payment happen automatically. Reminders at 15 and 30 days overdue. Discount and scholarship approval queue. QuickBooks connection, then monthly P&L.	Removes most manual invoicing and lowers the risk of billing errors.	Dec–Mar
HR & admin	Hiring, onboarding and compliance tracked in documents and email.	Onboarding and offboarding checklists, a job application form and recruiting funnel, a multi-state compliance calendar, payroll and commission checklists, and secure document storage.	Consistent processes as the team grows.	Jan–Feb
Editorial & curriculum	Lessons written, edited and assembled by hand. Scripture pasted and formatted manually (1,000+ verses in one guide). Versions tracked in email.	Next phase: an editorial hub with a review and doctrine-check workflow, automatic Scripture insertion, a production tracker and version control.	Faster, safer curriculum updates delivered digitally.	After Mar 2027
Leadership & board	~330 reports, many duplicated, so numbers differ depending on who ran them. Reports are stale by the time they are compiled.	One live dashboard: website visit, enquiry, demo, quote, won, teaching, renewed. Revenue booked vs. collected, return per conference, and a weekly leadership email.	Decisions made on today's numbers.	Jan–Mar

Return on investment: sales, renewals and time (estimates)

- **New sales:** Each new school averages about $2,267 in its first year and typically renews year after year. Ten more schools won ≈ $23,000 in year one, and the value repeats as they renew.

- **Win more of the schools that already ask:** Faster follow-up, online quotes and instant enquiry routing mean fewer interested schools slip away. Each 1-point gain in close rate ≈ one more school a year.
- **Renewals:** Each 1-point gain in renewal rate ≈ 4 schools ≈ $13,000 a year, every year.
- **Staff time (conservative floor):** About 960 staff hours a year can be counted from logged work alone. That covers new-sale and renewal paperwork, invoicing, set-up and logins. It does not yet count enquiry handling, demo booking, sample requests, conference follow-up, accounting proofing, the daily spreadsheet, support, marketing or HR, so the real figure is higher.
- **Measurable from day one:** We have limited hard data on today's processes because the time, effort and cost each department spends was never tracked. The portal changes that: every department's workload, cycle times and costs will be measured automatically and kept current every day, so leadership, the board and donors can see results as they happen.
- **Speed:** Payment-to-teaching drops from 5–7 days to 1–2. Hand-offs drop from 10+ to 2–3 per new school and from 15+ to 0–1 per renewal.
- **The future:** DeepRoots serves 78,000+ students in 384 schools, and the goal is 350,000 students. Automation lets the company grow without adding staff at the same rate.